

Welcome to Sucafina

sucafina.com

Company Overview

Sucafina is a privately held, Geneva-based multinational coffee merchant founded in 1977, operating as one of the world's leading 'Farm to Roaster' coffee companies with 1,500+ employees across 44 countries and a family tradition in commodities dating to 1905. The company operates at every level of the coffee supply chain — from direct farmer sourcing in origin countries (Africa, Latin America, Asia) through green coffee trading, roasting (Beyers Koffie), instant coffee (TB Brown), and specialty importing (Sustainable Harvest) — all underpinned by its IMPACT sustainability program. Sucafina has \$1.39B in raised financing and has shown a consistent push toward supply chain digitalization, with partnerships with CargoX (shipping automation), Cargoo (ocean freight), Komgo (digital trade finance), and its own Farmer Connect blockchain traceability platform.

Industry: Commodity Trading / Coffee Supply Chain

Company Size: 1,500+ employees across 44 countries

Country: Switzerland

AI Opportunities

1. Roaster Onboarding & Coffee Sourcing Assistant

Sucafina operates a self-serve online portal for roasters to browse offerings, request samples, and place orders — but new roaster onboarding still relies heavily on traders fielding emails and calls. A conversational agent on the web portal (and WhatsApp/email) could guide new roasters through account creation, explain IMPACT certification tiers, recommend coffees based on budget and flavor profile, and escalate to a trader only when genuinely needed. Given that Sucafina serves thousands of roasters across 44 countries, reducing trader time spent on early-stage qualification and intake questions has measurable efficiency value.

Impact: medium

2. Shipment & Order Status Agent

Sucafina manages complex multi-leg logistics — from origin farms through warehouses (NJ, Seattle, Antwerp, China) to roasters — in coordination with partners like CargoX and Cargoo. Roasters and internal operations staff currently have to contact teams to get status updates. A webhook-driven agent connected to shipping platforms and the internal ERP (SAP, as indicated in their tech stack) could automatically notify roasters of shipment milestones, delays, or document readiness (CMR, packing lists, BL), and allow self-service order tracking. This directly addresses the high-touch, email-heavy logistics communication Sucafina has already been trying to automate.

Impact: high

3. Global Trade Compliance & Sustainability Reporting Monitor

Sucafina's IMPACT program involves ongoing sustainability verification across 44 countries — including environmental, social, and economic compliance standards. Monitoring this at scale involves aggregating data from origin partners, certifiers, and internal systems. A scheduled agent could pull data from connected systems nightly, flag compliance gaps or expiring certifications, and generate weekly summary reports for Sucafina's sustainability and trading teams. This is exactly the kind of cross-system, background data aggregation that Lua's LuaJob + webhook architecture handles natively.

Impact: medium

4. Internal Trader Knowledge & Pricing Assistant

Sucafina's traders operate across 44 countries and must rapidly digest origin market conditions, price fluctuations, certification statuses, and roaster contract histories. An internal Slack-based agent connected to their SAP ERP, internal databases, and market data feeds could answer trader queries like 'What's our current Uganda Arabica stock position?' or 'Which roasters have contracts expiring in 30 days?' — reducing time spent hunting across systems. With ZoomInfo noting active Operations and Sales hiring surges, internal tooling that amplifies trader productivity is a strong fit for their growth phase.

Impact: high

5. Microsoft Fabric Data Pipeline Anomaly Alerting Agent

Sucafina is actively hiring Microsoft Fabric Data Engineers and Data Quality Engineers in Beirut — signaling a major investment in a modern data warehouse and pipeline infrastructure. An event-driven agent sitting on top of their Fabric pipelines could detect anomalies in data freshness, integration failures, or quality threshold breaches and immediately notify the right engineering or finance team via Slack or email — without requiring engineers to manually monitor dashboards. This bridges the gap between their data platform investment and operational responsiveness.

Impact: medium

Recommended Implementations

1. Implementation 1

A web-embedded agent (via LuaPop) that serves Sucafina's roaster customers directly on their regional portals (NA, EMEA, APAC). When a roaster lands on the site, the agent accesses the live offerings list and answers questions like 'Do you have a washed Ethiopian Yirgacheffe under \$3/lb arriving before September?' or 'What's available from Rwanda with Rainforest Alliance cert?' — then writes a sample request directly into Sucafina's online portal on the roaster's behalf. It can also pull shipping timeline data from Cargoo/CargoX integrations, explain IMPACT certification tiers, and route complex contracting questions to the correct regional trader via email (PostProcessor appends the roaster's account ID and region before handoff). Replaces the current 'email a trader and wait' flow for discovery and sampling.

2. Implementation 2

Sucafina already uses Cargoo and CargoX for ocean freight digitalization, but event data from these platforms currently requires manual monitoring. This agent registers a LuaWebhook endpoint that receives shipment status events from Cargoo's API (booking confirmed, Bill of Lading issued, container departed, ETA updated, demurrage risk flagged). On each event, the agent queries SAP for the linked contract and customer account, evaluates whether the ETA deviation breaches an SLA threshold, and if so: (1) updates the internal logistics record in SAP, (2) sends a proactive email to the roaster with the updated arrival window and adjusted release date, and (3) if demurrage risk is detected, creates a flagged task in the internal CRM for the responsible trader. Eliminates the reactive 'roaster calls to ask where their coffee is' loop and protects Sucafina from demurrage costs through early intervention.

3. Implementation 3

Sucafina manages IMPACT Verified status for supply chains across 16+ origins, with third-party audits every 3 years and continuous indicator tracking across 82 compliance criteria per farm. This agent runs on a LuaJob weekly schedule: it queries the IMPACT program database for farms approaching audit renewal windows (within 90 days), checks indicator completion rates against the 50% minimum threshold, identifies supply chains where Critical Indicator compliance has dropped, and generates a prioritized action report. The report is delivered via email to regional sustainability managers and posted to the relevant Slack channel. On a separate monthly schedule, it aggregates carbon, deforestation, and living income KPIs across origins and generates the data tables used for the annual Sustainability Report — pulling from satellite monitoring integrations (Trade in Space), farm geo-data, and SAP procurement records to produce a cross-system dataset.

4. Implementation 4

Currently, a new roaster fills out a form, then waits for a trader to manually review and follow up. This agent activates when a new account registration is submitted (LuaWebhook on form submission event). It immediately: (1) sends a confirmation email with next steps, (2) starts a guided web chat conversation asking structured qualification questions (annual green coffee volume, origins of interest, certifications needed, preferred payment terms), (3) writes the collected profile data into the CRM against the new account, (4) checks if the roaster meets the criteria for net-30 credit terms (volume threshold, market region) and pre-fills the credit application with known data, and (5) routes the completed profile to the correct regional trader with a warm summary. Reduces the current 24–72hr gap between signup and first trader contact to under 10 minutes, and gives traders a pre-qualified lead instead of a blank form.

5. Implementation 5

Sucafina's 1,500+ staff across 44 countries need to stay current on coffee market prices, weather events at origin, regulatory changes (especially EUDR deforestation compliance deadlines), and competitor activity. This agent runs every weekday morning via LuaJob, pulling from ICE/NYSE Arabica and Robusta futures APIs for price movement alerts, querying weather and agronomic data APIs for active growing regions (Colombia, Ethiopia, Rwanda, Vietnam, Brazil), scanning regulatory feeds for EUDR and Global Coffee Platform updates, and cross-referencing against Sucafina's open contract book (from SAP) to flag positions exposed to price or supply disruption. Each regional trading desk receives a tailored digest — East Africa desk gets Rwanda/Burundi/Ethiopia signals, NA desk gets Colombian and Central American data — delivered to Slack and email before the trading day opens. Replaces ad-hoc Google searches and fragmented email chains with a structured, actionable morning brief.

Competitive Landscape

Key Competitors:

- Neumann Kaffee Gruppe
- Volcafe (ED&F Man)
- Olam International (ofi)
- ECOM Agroindustrial Corp
- Louis Dreyfus Company (Coffee Division)

Sales Insights

Pain Points:

- Cross-system data fragmentation across 44 countries: Sucafina runs SAP S/4HANA, NetSuite, Signavio, Cargoo, CargoX, Komgo, and Agrosmart across a sprawling 1,500-person, 44-country operation. Their own Chief Transformation Officer sits on the ICC Digital Standards Initiative board — signaling that siloed, cross-platform data coordination is a live leadership-level pain. Agents that bridge these systems (e.g., triggering SAP updates from logistics webhooks, auto-reconciling Komgo borrowing base data) would address a real bottleneck.
- Trader and logistics coordination still leans on email: Sucafina's own case study with Cargoo quantified the problem — 60% reduction in shipping instruction time and 70% of shipping volume automated only after deploying a SaaS layer. That 30% still running on manual email exchange is a target. Lua webhook-triggered agents could auto-process shipping events from Cargoo/CargoX into internal records, reducing trader coordination overhead significantly.
- Sustainability compliance reporting is manual and fragmented: Sucafina's IMPACT program, EU EUDR (deforestation regulation) compliance, and their \$500M sustainability-linked borrowing base facility all require continuous data collection and reporting across origin countries. Today this is largely human-assembled. Scheduled Lua agents could aggregate data from Agrosmart, Komgo, and origin warehouses nightly and generate compliance-ready reports automatically.
- Roaster client onboarding and order management across regional entities (EMEA, NA, Asia) lacks automation: Sucafina operates distinct regional entities serving roasters who need coffee samples, pricing quotes, lot availability, and order updates. Each of these touchpoints is likely handled manually by traders. An internal agent connected to their CRM (HubSpot or SAP) and product catalog could handle routine roaster inquiries, sample request routing, and order status updates — freeing traders for relationship work.
- Internal knowledge management across a 44-country team: With 1,500 employees spanning origin-country exporters, Geneva traders, and destination roaster-facing sales teams, institutional knowledge about coffee lots, counterparty relationships, logistics lanes, and sustainability certifications is almost certainly trapped in inboxes and individuals. A Lua-powered internal agent over their knowledge base (Kontent.ai CMS + SharePoint/Teams) could surface answers that today require interrupting a Geneva senior trader.

Talking Points:

- Lead with their transformation agenda, not our product: Sucafina has a Chief Transformation Officer on the ICC Digital Standards Initiative board and is a published case study in supply chain digitalization. Open with: 'You're already leading the industry on digital trade standards — we want to understand where the automation gaps are inside your own operations, because the external integrations you've built (CargoX, Komgo) each solved one lane. We help connect them.'
- The 30% manual logistics gap is a specific, quantified opening: Their CargoX case study shows 70% of shipping volume is automated, with 50% efficiency gains — which implicitly means 30% is still manual. Lua can deploy webhook-triggered agents that receive events from CargoX/CargoX and take downstream actions in SAP or NetSuite without human intervention. This is a concrete, scoped first use case with measurable ROI.
- Frame around the multi-system, multi-country coordination problem: Sucafina's real complexity isn't any one system — it's that SAP, Komgo, Agrosmart, CargoX, and origin-country tools don't talk to each other autonomously. Lua agents act as cross-system orchestrators: 'When a shipment event fires in CargoX, the agent updates Komgo collateral records and alerts the Geneva trader in Teams — no one has to do that manually.' That's the Lua value prop in their language.
- Sustainability reporting automation is a board-level concern given their \$500M sustainability-linked borrowing base: Their ING-led facility requires continuous collateral and ESG data transparency. Komgo's Digital Agent already does part of this — but Lua could run nightly scheduled jobs that pull from Agrosmart farm data, warehouse holding certificates, and shipping manifests to auto-generate the compliance artifacts their 15 lender banks need. Tie this to their EUDR compliance burden for added urgency.
- The honest scope discussion: Sucafina is not a software company and has a lean tech team (hiring a Data Integrations Engineer in Beirut suggests limited internal build capacity). They buy technology, they don't build it from scratch. Lua's TypeScript-first, CLI-driven developer platform is best positioned as a tool for their integration/data team to ship agents quickly — not as a no-code tool for business users. The right buyer is their CTO or Chief Transformation Officer, and the right pitch is 'your integrations team ships their first agent in days, not months.'

Objection Handlers:

- 'We already have CargoX, CargoX, Komgo, and SAP handling our automation — we don't need another platform.'! Those tools each automate one lane excellently. What none of t across lanes — when CargoX fires a shipping event, something still has to touch Komgo, update SAP, and notify the Geneva trader. That coordination work either falls on a human or it doesn't happen. Lua is the layer that closes that gap without requiring a new enterprise implementation.
- 'We have a small engineering team — we can't take on a new developer p l actually the argument for Lua, not against it. Building cross-system agents in-house using raw APIs takes 6-12 months before you write a single line of business logic. Lua ships in days. A single Data Integrations Engineer can have a working agent connecting CargoX webhooks to SAP in a week — your team writes the business logic, Lua handles the infrastructure.
- 'We prefer to work with established enterprise vendors like SAP or our ex fair — and Lua doesn't replace those. It connects them. SAP and CargoX both expose APIs and webhooks; Lua agents sit on top of those to automate the coordination between them. Think of it as the operational layer that makes your existing enterprise stack act as one system rather than five separate ones.

- 'Our transformation roadmap is already defined — we're not evaluating new options, we're asking for a full evaluation. The fastest path is to pick one specific manual process — the remaining 30% of logistics coordination that's still on email, or the monthly IMPACT compliance report that someone assembles by hand — and let your team run a two-week pilot. If it doesn't ship a working agent, there's no contract to sign. The goal is to show what your integration team can do in a week, not to replace your roadmap.'

Estimated Deal Value: \$8k-18k/month